IT & Deployment Documentation

Community Mental Health Signposting Portal (Escale)

Role: IT Assistant | **Updated Date:** August 14, 2026

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Part 1: System Requirements

Author: IT Assistant | Date: August 14, 2026

1. Purpose

This document defines the technical requirements used to build, deploy, and maintain the **Escale** portal prototype. It serves as a guide for understanding the project's tooling, stack selection, and deployment setup via **Google AI Studio**.

2. Functional Requirements

- **Search & Browse:** Users can browse and filter mental health resources, support groups, and crisis lines by category and format (in-person vs. virtual).
- **Zero Barrier Access:** Users can access all services instantly without creating an account or logging in.
- **Content Management:** Resource data (names, descriptions, contacts, verification dates, capacity) can be managed via clean source files (`/src` data files) without re-architecting application logic.
- **Privacy-by-Design:** No personal identifying health data or user credentials are generated, stored, or logged.

3. Technical Stack

Layer	Recommendation / Technology	Notes
Development Engine	Google AI Studio	Integrated prompt-driven web app builder used to design and generate the application.
Frontend Framework	React (TypeScript / Vite)	Modular component architecture built with Tailwind CSS for high-contrast, accessible styling.
Hosting & Cloud Infrastructure	Google Cloud Run *(via AI Studio Publish)*	Automated hosting providing instant HTTPS `.run.app` live deployments.
Version Control & Submission	School GitHub Repository	Primary repository storing exported project source files (`/src` , `package.json` , `README.md`).

3a. Hosting Options Considered

Platform	Best for	Free Tier Notes	Status / Watch out for
Google Cloud Run	Google AI Studio web apps	**Primary Choice:** One-click deployment from AI Studio; automatic HTTPS.	Direct web-based preview generated during build process.
Netlify	Static/Jamstack sites	Credit-based free tier (~300 credits/mo).	Requires connecting GitHub repository to third-party CI/CD.
Vercel	React/Next.js apps	Generous build allowance.	Requires credit card verification on Hobby tiers.

4. Non-Functional Requirements

- **Performance:** Mobile page loads optimized via Vite build bundling under 2 seconds.
- **Accessibility:** Designed to meet WCAG 2.1 AA basics (pastel palette, dark charcoal high-contrast text, clear focus states, and keyboard-navigable crisis modals).
- **Security:** Enforced HTTPS encryption; stateless architecture collecting no user telemetry or health records.
- **Device Support:** Fully responsive across mobile, tablet, and desktop viewports down to 360px width.

Part 2: Deployment Plan

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1. Objective

Deploy a working prototype of the **Escale** portal using Google AI Studio while maintaining a clean copy of the full codebase in the school's GitHub repository.

2. Deployment Architecture

```
                Google AI Studio (App Builder)
                              |
   ├──► [Publish Button] ──► Google Cloud Run (Live Prototype URL: *.run.app)
                              |
└──► [Export Code] ──► Local Computer (Unzip) ──► School GitHub Repository (Main Branch)
```

3. Deployment Steps

1. **Build & Test in AI Studio:** Validate page layouts, crisis modals, and support group listings visually using Build Mode.
2. **Instant Prototype Deployment:** Click **Publish** inside Google AI Studio to launch the live application on **Google Cloud Run** and receive a live public URL (`*.run.app`).
3. **Export Codebase:** Use **Share** / **Download** to export the project as a `.zip` archive containing all React components, assets, and dependencies.
4. **Extract Local Archive:** Unzip `escale.zip` on your local machine.
5. **Upload to School GitHub Repository:**
    - *Option A (VS Code Terminal):* Run `git init` , `git add .` , `git commit -m "Upload Escale project"` , and `git push -u origin main` .
    - *Option B (GitHub Web):* Use the **Upload files** feature on the school's GitHub repository page to upload the extracted files.

Part 3: Maintenance Plan

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1. Objective

Provide straightforward routines for future maintainers to keep resource listings current, update crisis information, and push maintenance commits to GitHub.

2. Content Update Procedure

1. Open the project in **VS Code** (via `File` → `Open Folder...`).
2. Open the resource data files (e.g., inside `/src/data/` or `/src/components/`).
3. Update resource details (names, phone numbers, capacities, or verification timestamps).
4. Commit and push the updated files to the school GitHub repository:

```
git add .
git commit -m "Update community resource verified dates"
git push origin main
```

Part 4: User Support Guide

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Part A: For Portal Users

- **Privacy:** Escale requires no login or account creation, and stores no personal or sensitive user data.
- **Immediate Crisis Access:** Users in distress can click the high-priority **"Crisis Help"** button in the top navigation bar to open immediate helpline details and safety options.

Part B: Common Issues & Fixes for Maintainers

Issue	Likely Cause	Fix
Garbled symbols when opening files	Trying to open `escale.zip` directly in VS Code instead of extracting it first.	Unzip/extract `escale.zip` in Windows File Explorer/ Finder, then use **File** → **Open Folder** in VS Code.
VS Code asks to select a file	Selected *Open File* instead of *Open Folder*.	Click **File** → **Open Folder...** and select the main `escale` folder.
API Keys exposed	Hardcoded keys in client code.	Move keys to a `.env.local` file and ensure `.env.local` is included in `.gitignore` before pushing to GitHub.